

Policy Number	UME.AC.119
Policy Title	Perelman School of Medicine at the University of Pennsylvania Undergraduate Medical Education Program Policy on Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence
Effective Date	07/21/2026
Last Revision Date (if any)	N/A
Scope	All undergraduate medical students (UME) and faculty within instructional roles within UME courses and clinical training environments
LCME Element(s) (if any)	N/A

Perelman School of Medicine at the University of Pennsylvania Undergraduate Medical Education Program Policy on Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence

I. PURPOSE and BACKGROUND

This policy establishes the appropriate use of artificial intelligence (AI) within Undergraduate Medical Education (UME) at PSOM. It aims to support innovation while preserving independent critical thinking, academic integrity, and data privacy.

AI tools can enhance learning and efficiency but also pose risks related to accuracy, bias, overreliance, and inappropriate data use. AI tools are intended to support, not replace, the development of independent clinical reasoning, critical thinking, and professional judgment. This policy also provides guardrails to ensure responsible, ethical, and secure use.

II. SCOPE

This policy applies to all Perelman School of Medicine (PSOM) students in UME and faculty in their instructional roles within UME courses and clinical training environments. Students enrolled in Biomedical Graduate Studies (BGS), Master's Degree programs, and other distinct PSOM programs and courses should reference their program specific policies and consult with their course directors for additional guidance.

This policy does not govern faculty, staff, or clinical operations outside the UME educational context. Those groups should refer to relevant PSOM, Penn Medicine, Graduate Medical Education (GME), and other applicable institutional AI policies.

This policy is designed to align with and complement existing University and Health System policies.

III. POLICY and GUIDELINES

The use of AI tools at PSOM must align with the [University of Pennsylvania's Acceptable Use Policy for Electronic Resources](#).

Definitions

- “Artificial intelligence (AI)” refers to the ability and development of computer machines to perform tasks that previously would require human intelligence such as recognizing patterns, synthesizing data, problem solving, and adapting to new information.
- “Generative artificial intelligence (GenAI) such as large language models (LLMs)” refers to any technology or application that can generate text, images, audio, videos, and other media based on a user-submitted prompt.
- “Public AI tools” refers to any service not licensed/contracted by Penn/PSOM/UPHS, while “approved tools” refers to those services specifically listed on the [PMACS Website](#).

Core Principles

- All users are responsible for the accuracy, integrity, and appropriate use of AI-generated content. Outputs should be verified using trusted sources, and use must comply with institutional policies related to academic integrity, privacy, and data security.

Classroom and Coursework

- Use of GenAI is not permitted in assignments, examinations, or other academic work unless explicitly authorized by course faculty.
- When GenAI use is permitted, students must follow faculty instructions. Students remain responsible for the accuracy of all AI-assisted work.
- PSOM curricular materials (including but not limited to slides, small group handouts, study guides, practice questions, course syllabi, etc.) may only be uploaded into PSOM approved AI tools.
- Faculty, students, and staff are **not** permitted to input PSOM curricular material into publicly available GenAI applications without the advance written approval of content authors or PSOM leadership. These guidelines are in place to protect intellectual property and copyright laws and will be enforced as described in the “Violations of Conduct” section below.

Clinical Learning Environment

- AI use in clinical settings requires supervising faculty notification and approval and must align with site-specific policies. Unauthorized use of AI applications to create clinical documentation will be grounds for failing an assignment, course, or clerkship, and may initiate an academic review of professionalism.
- AI tools may only be used for clinical documentation if they are approved and integrated within Penn Medicine and/or Children’s Hospital of Philadelphia (CHOP) clinical systems. Use of non-approved AI tools for clinical documentation is prohibited. Violations may result in failure of an assignment, course, or clerkship and may trigger an academic review of professionalism.
- Use of AI tools such as Open Evidence for clinical decision support may be permitted in the clinical learning environment depending on the educational context, and only at the discretion of and with permission from individual course directors. Users of AI tools should verify all AI-generated content and remain responsible for accuracy.

- Students must follow AI policies at all clinical training sites. While most align with PSOM/Penn Medicine policies, some external sites, including but not limited to, the Philadelphia Veterans Affairs (VA) hospital and CHOP may have additional requirements. If available, please refer to individual site-specific AI policies for guidance on AI tools that are acceptable for direct patient care.

Scholarly Work

- AI use should be cited, and users remain responsible for accuracy, integrity, and compliance with applicable policies and laws.
- Students must not enter their own or others' unpublished or experimental data, grant proposals, proprietary or copyright-protected information, or confidential material into public AI platforms without the expressed permission of their faculty supervisor.
- Use of AI tools with sensitive research data including HIPAA and FERPA-protected information should be discussed with supervising faculty.
- Students and faculty must follow AI policies required by journals, professional organizations, or conferences when producing scholarly work.
- Students and faculty should disclose the use of AI tools in the development of manuscripts, presentations, posters, and abstracts per journal and meeting guidelines.

Data Security and Approved Tools

- Users must follow [Penn Data Risk Classifications](#) and use only institutionally approved AI tools for any sensitive or protected data.
- Currently approved PSOM AI Tools can be found at [PMACS AI Tools](#), which provides a quick visual overview and additional guidance on:
 - Which AI tools are approved for use at PSOM
 - What types of data may and may not be used in each tool
 - Key reminders related to privacy, security, and compliance (HIPAA/FERPA)
- Confidential, restricted, proprietary, or legally protected information ("Protected Data" ex: PHI, learner data protected under FERPA, internal PSOM documents, etc.) may not be entered into any public AI tools.
- Use of public AI tools with nonconfidential, nonrestricted, and nonproprietary data is generally permissible, provided users comply with applicable intellectual property, attribution, and academic integrity standards.
 - AI tools must be used in a way that honors copyrights, patents, and trademarks. Avoid any unauthorized copying or sharing of protected materials.
- Additional detailed data-use guidance is maintained at the following resources:
 - [UPHS AI Tools](#)
 - [Information Systems and Computing Generative AI Tools and Resources](#)

Disclosure and Accountability

- Use of AI must be appropriately cited within academic work. Please see [CETLI's Guidance on Citing AI Contributions](#) for additional guidance.
- Unauthorized use of AI within coursework, including failure to disclose use, may be considered a violation of academic integrity and may result in disciplinary action consistent with PSOM policies.
- Users of AI must accept responsibility for generated content, including potential inaccuracies, misinformation, biases, or violations of privacy, professionalism, intellectual property, or codes of conduct, among other potential faults.

Faculty Responsibilities

- Faculty are responsible for ensuring appropriate supervision and oversight of AI use in educational, research, and clinical contexts.
- Faculty must clearly communicate expectations for AI use in their courses and clinical rotations (e.g., in syllabi, course websites, or verbal guidance). Course syllabi should include a statement of acceptable use of AI in the course, including a hyperlink to this policy. Please reference [CETLI Guidance on GenAI Resources](#) for additional guidance.
- When AI use is permitted for coursework, faculty must clearly define acceptable and prohibited uses, and provide guidance on appropriate documentation, attribution, and validation of AI-assisted work.
- Faculty should disclose to students when AI was used in the creation of course materials and assignments. Please see the [Statement on Guidance for the University of Pennsylvania Community on Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence](#). Faculty retain responsibility for accuracy and alignment of AI generated content with course objectives.
- PSOM acknowledges that access to AI tools may vary. Faculty should design assignments that do not disadvantage learners without access to premium tools.
Use of AI detection software is generally discouraged as its accuracy is imperfect and typically insufficient as evidence that a student has used AI. Uploading student work to an AI detector may also violate FERPA.

Violations of Conduct

- Students, faculty, and staff should report suspected misuse, data security and privacy concerns in the use of AI tools. Reports made in good faith are protected from retaliation.
- Allegations of misconduct related to AI use may be reported through the following mechanisms. Consequences of misconduct will be presented to the Professionalism Subcommittee of the Student Standards Committee (SSC), and outcomes will be determined on a case-by-case basis.
 - Reports may be submitted confidentially online through the [Professionalism at PSOM Portal](#) by anyone with a PennKey, including students, housestaff, faculty, staff, and administration. Alternatively, reports can also be made to the Academic Programs Office administrators or any of the Associate and Assistant Deans, and the Vice Dean for Undergraduate Medical Education (VD-UME).
 - Any course director who determines that there is an immediate professionalism concern will report the issue directly to the Associate Dean for Student Affairs and Wellness.
 - Individual evaluators in courses or clerkships may submit an evaluation which documents a professionalism issue or concerns which are reviewed by the Office of the Registrar. This will alert the appropriate departmental administrator.

Ongoing Review:

- This policy will be reviewed at least annually, with interim updates as needed based on emerging technologies, regulatory changes, or institutional priorities and policies. Students and faculty are responsible for staying informed of any changes to this policy.
- Feedback on this policy will inform ongoing revisions and may be submitted to the Medical Education Technology Committee (METC@pennmedicine.upenn.edu).

IV. POLICY AUTHOR(S)

This policy is overseen by the Undergraduate Medical Education Committee (UMEC), in collaboration with PSOM leadership, Penn Medicine IT, the PSOM Medical Education Technology Committee (METC) and institutional data governance bodies.

Contributors: Stacey Kassutto, Flint Wang, Nathaniel Srikureja, Daniel Lai, Zoe Barinaga, Suzana Tsao, Daniel DiPietro, Rosalyn Schorr, Vivian Lee, Charles Bae, Nadia Bennett, Tessa Cook, Neha Patel, Andrew King, William Vervilles, Leah Carr.

This policy was developed with the assistance of OpenAI's ChatGPT Edu and Microsoft CoPilot (September-October 2025 and July 2026), which provided examples and frameworks drawn from publicly available institutional AI policies.

V. REFERENCES

[AAMC AI Policy Development Checklist for Medical Education](#)

[Academic Performance and Progression](#)

[Academic Review of Professionalism](#)

[Code of Academic Integrity](#)

[Generative AI and Your Teaching \(CETLI\)](#)

[Information Systems and Computing Generative AI Tools and Resources](#)

[Penn Data Risk Classification](#)

[PMACS AI Tools](#)

[Professionalism at PSOM Portal](#)

[Statement on Guidance for the University of Pennsylvania Community on Use of Generative Artificial Intelligence](#)

[Student Standards Committee](#)

[UPHS AI Tools](#)

VI. GOVERNING BODY

Undergraduate Medical Education Committee

VII. POLICY HISTORY

Date	Change
07/21/2026	Approved and Effective